Zain Dana Harper

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Technical Support and QA Engineer

Summary

I turn reported failures into reproducible tests and clear write-ups. Maintainers of 34 open-source projects have merged 41 of my pull requests, and I have worked Xbox networking support by phone and chat. About thirteen years of programming, and eleven years of commercial tree care scoping jobs and coordinating crews.

Selected Results

- Merged 41 pull requests in 34 other people's projects, 3 of them list entries, counted November 14, 2026. Datasette #2815 turned a server error on malformed row URLs into a client error, with tests. Hebbian Robotics #157 added a test that reports schema drift in both directions. Voxwire #44 added offline replay coverage for a degraded voice turn. harperz9.github.io/portfolio.html
- Shipped Flywheel 1.9.0 on PyPI, Homebrew and Scoop with a Windows installer, Articulate 0.18.0 on PyPI, and CMMNS 3.10.0 as a GitHub release. Versions read November 14, 2026.
- Released and updated Elder ENB, a Skyrim lighting mod: 1,004,693 downloads (179,218 unique) and 2,418 endorsements as of November 13, 2026. nexusmods.com/skyrimspecialedition/mods/117327
- Published 30 research findings, 12 of them nulls, each with the steps to repeat it. Not peer reviewed. harperz9.github.io/findings/

Experience

Arboriculture and Field Operations | Legendary Tree

Seattle area | April 25, 2015 to June 2, 2026

- Turned site assessments into estimates and job scopes; coordinated clients, crews and vendors on access, timing and hazards; watched rigging and clearances from the ground.

Technical Networking Support | Stream/Convergys | 2014 to 2015

- Resolved Xbox connectivity problems on a Microsoft product contract in Wilsonville, Oregon, by phone and chat, across TCP/IP, DNS, NAT, firewalls and routers; documented the steps for support handoffs.

I have not yet held a paid software role. The software on this page is independent work.

Projects

- Built Flywheel, a Python/Flutter AI workstation with permission-checked tools; sorted all 324 combinations of its evaluation record into seven verdicts that separate provider failures from model-quality scores.
- Built Articulate, a prose checker; Accountable Surface approval interfaces; and CMMNS, a browser extension that shows the sources behind social media replies.
- Wrote guides, API documentation and release notes as a freelance technical writer, from 2017.

I write with coding agents and review, test and release the work myself.

Education

High School Diploma | Wilsonville High School, Oregon | 2013

Credentials, 2026: 4 Microsoft Applied Skills including Azure DevOps pipeline security, 6 Qualys Certified Specialist exams, 2 Google Cloud BigQuery skill badges.

Skills

Python, SQL, Git, GitHub Actions, pytest, Linux, Windows, HTTP/JSON APIs, WebSocket, TCP/IP, DNS, NAT; issue reproduction, regression testing, release packaging, technical documentation.